Box for Less Platform Front-end plan

The screens, the journeys and how the team will build them, connected to Odoo. Prepared for the CEO and the sales team, to agree the next step.

1. Summary and what we ask for
2. How the platform fits with Odoo
3. Who uses it, and the screen map
4. Journey 1: a credit customer orders
5. Journey 2: a cash customer orders
6. Journey 3: expiry, in the warehouse and in the shop
7. Journey 4: payment reminders
8. Every screen, one by one
9. How the front end is built
10. Build order and the next step

Operations & Development · October 2026 · Companion documents: the technical specification and the clickable wireframes.

1 · SUMMARY

One platform for ordering, balances, expiry and reports, with Odoo as the master

Customers and sales reps order from a phone. Staff approve, follow up and report from a desktop. Every figure comes from Odoo; the platform adds the screens and the rules Odoo does not have.

3,883
active products in the catalogue today (8,933 in Odoo in total)

504
customers already loaded, each with an access code

18
screens: 9 for customers, 2 for sales reps, 7 for staff

What already works today (version 0.4.2)

- A customer catalogue on the phone: search, categories, stock status, carton quantities and a request cart.
- Access codes per customer, a staff admin with a dashboard, imports from the Odoo Excel export, and 290 automated tests.

What the new front end adds

- **Proper customer accounts** instead of access codes, for credit customers (companies) and cash customers.
- **Prices per carton** from each customer's Odoo price class, shown only to approved customers.
- **Orders that land in Odoo as quotations** for the Sales Manager to approve, with the same order number in both systems.
- **The customer's balance**, invoices and a credit-limit check before an order is sent.
- **Expiry control** in the warehouse and on customers' shelves, with discounts approved by the Sales Manager.
- **Payment reminders** on each customer's own schedule, and **monthly reports** for the CEO and managers.

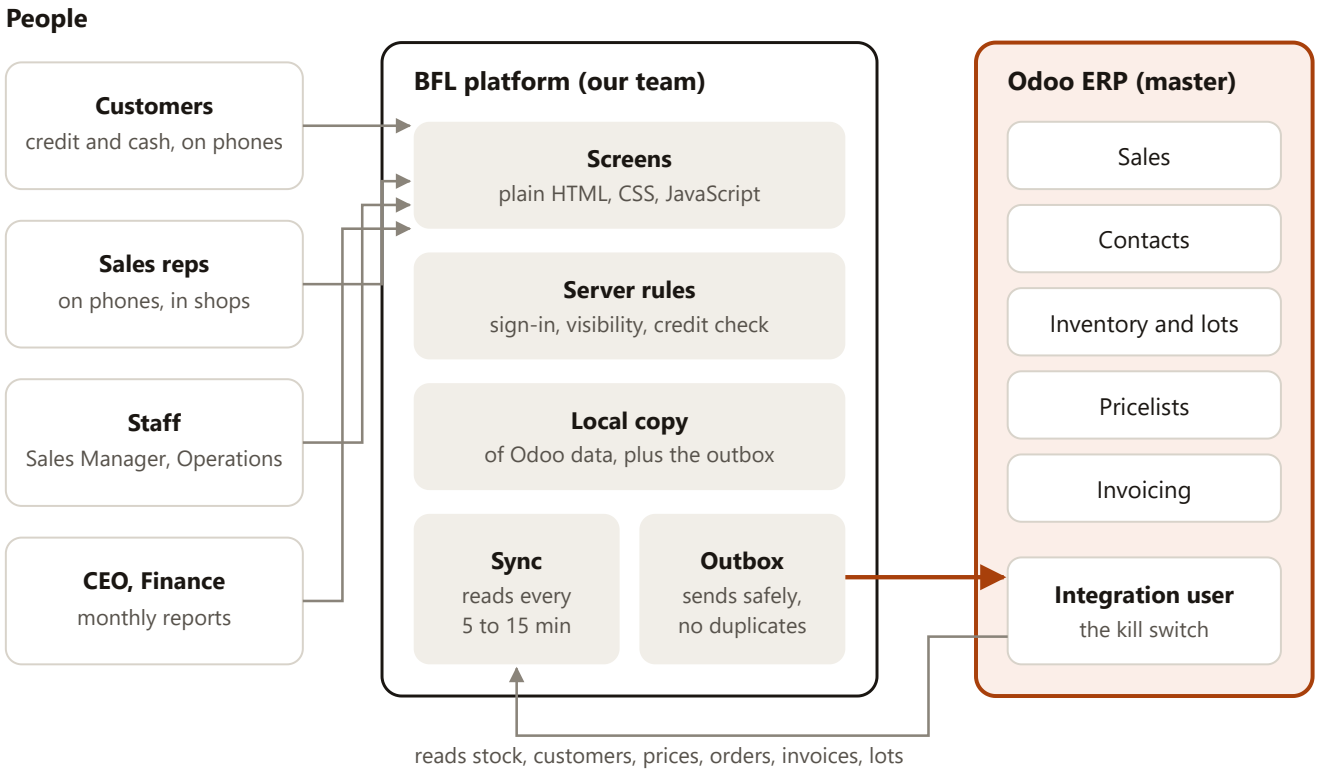
What we ask for at this meeting

1. Agreement on the screens and journeys in this document.
2. A go-ahead for Phase 0: the budget, the two developers, the hosting and Odoo API access.
3. The sales team's help with the Odoo data clean-up (section 10) and the open policies.

2 · HOW IT FITS WITH ODOO

Odoo stays the master; the platform reads it and sends back only two things

The platform keeps a local copy of what it reads from Odoo, so screens are fast and keep working if Odoo is slow. It never edits Odoo's data. The only writes are draft quotations and, after approval, new credit customers. A person approves every order in Odoo.



Grey arrows: reading. Orange arrow: the only writes, draft quotations and approved new credit customers.

The platform never

- confirms, sends or cancels an order
- writes invoices, payments or stock moves
- changes prices, credit limits or products
- reads cost prices

Safety built in

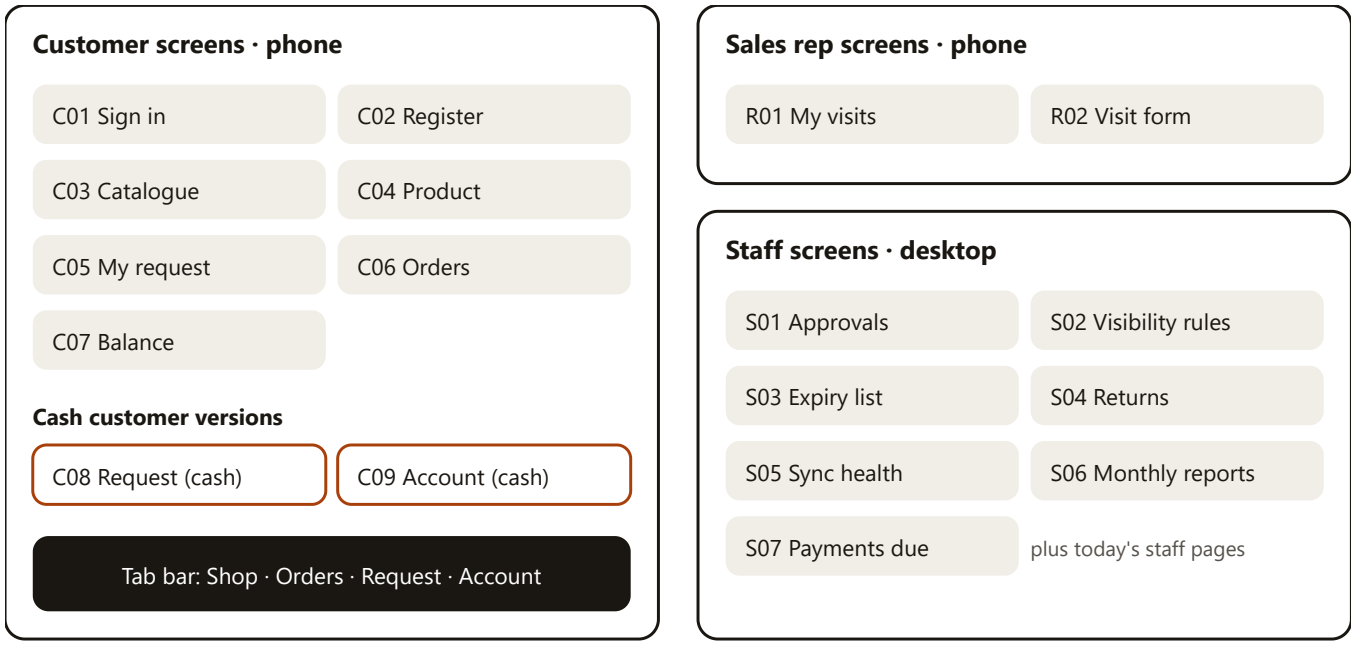
- built and tested on a copy of Odoo first
- one integration user; disabling it stops everything
- orders queue if Odoo is down, and never duplicate
- a daily report compares BFL with Odoo

3 · WHO USES IT

Six kinds of user, eighteen screens

User	Device	What they do on the platform
Credit customer (a company)	Phone	Browses with their own prices, orders, follows orders, sees balance and invoices, gets payment reminders.
Cash customer	Phone	Browses and orders for cash; no credit, balance or reminders. Their orders go on Odoo's shared cash account.
Sales rep	Phone	Orders for their own customers; checks short-dated stock on shop shelves and proposes discounts.
Sales Manager	Desktop	Approves new customers and discounts, sets visibility rules and payment schedules, approves quotations in Odoo.
Operations and Warehouse	Desktop	Acts on the expiry list, classifies returns, watches the sync health.
CEO and Finance	Email and desktop	Receive the monthly reports; Finance issues credit notes and records payments in Odoo.

The screen map



Reps order through the customer screens, with an "Ordering for" bar and only their own customers. Today's staff pages (Dashboard, Product Master, Change Review, Requests, Scan) stay.

4 · JOURNEY 1

A credit customer orders

From registration to a paid invoice. The customer always sees the Odoo order number, and the order changes their balance only when Odoo posts the invoice.

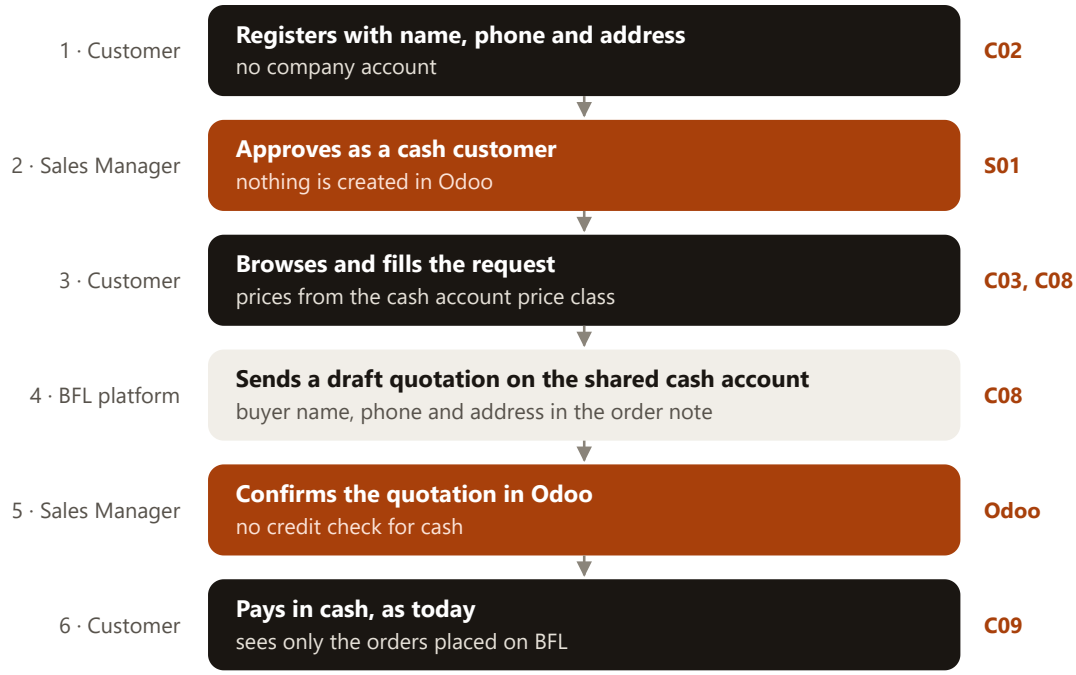


Colours show who acts: dark for the customer, orange for the Sales Manager, light for the platform, outlined for Odoo and the warehouse.

5 · JOURNEY 2

A cash customer orders

In Odoo, cash buyers share one account, and each buyer's name, phone and address go on their order. The platform keeps every cash buyer's own details, so they still get a normal account on BFL.



Privacy rule for the shared cash account

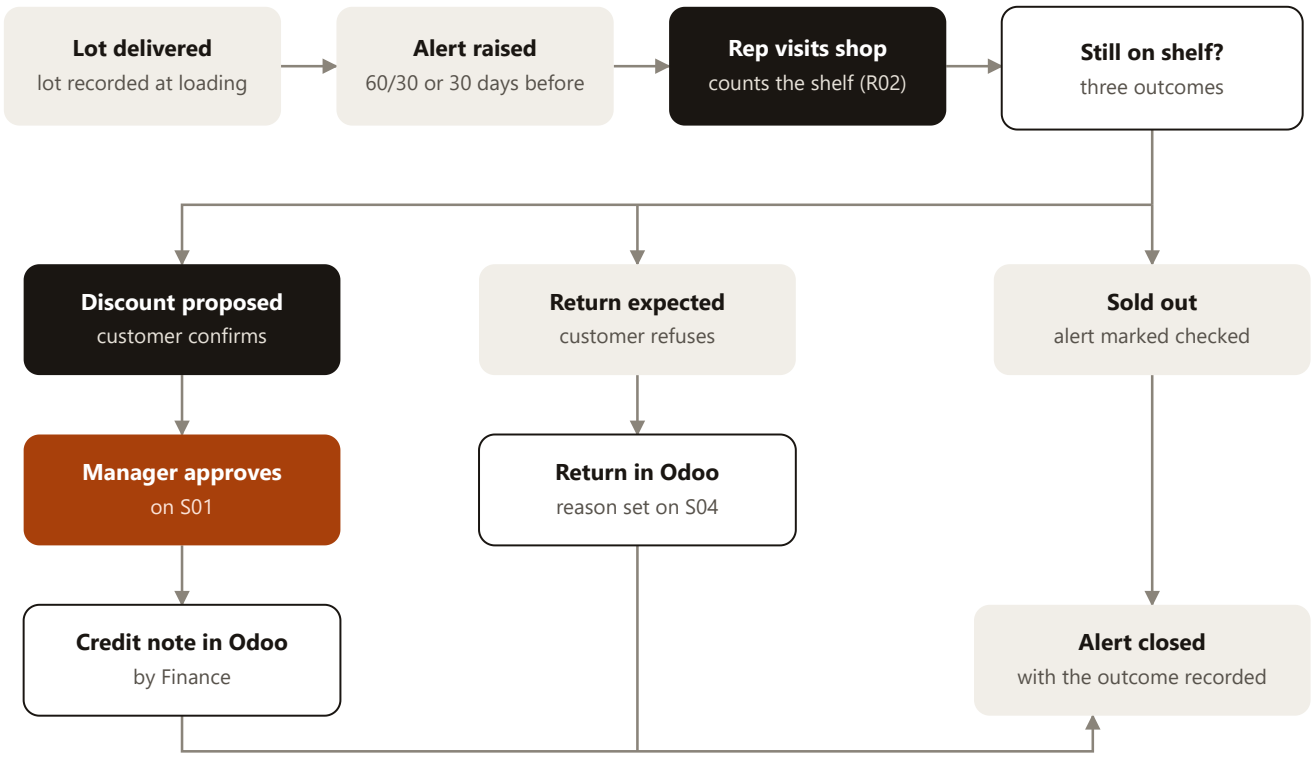
Because many buyers share it, BFL never shows that account's balance, invoices or order history to anyone. A cash customer sees only the orders they placed on BFL. Cash sales entered directly in Odoo cannot be linked to a buyer, so they are not shown.

6 · JOURNEY 3

Expiry: in our warehouse and on the customer's shelf

In the warehouse, every lot gets an expiry band (warning periods per category; shorter for 3 to 6 month products). Each lot in a band gets an action and an owner on the expiry list (S03). Short-dated stock moves to a **clearance location** and is sold on BFL at a discount, marked "not returnable for expiry".

On the customer's shelf, every delivered lot is tracked from the moment the truck is loaded. Before it expires, the rep visits the shop:



A discount costs less than a return. A customer who accepts one confirms that the lot will not be returned for expiry.

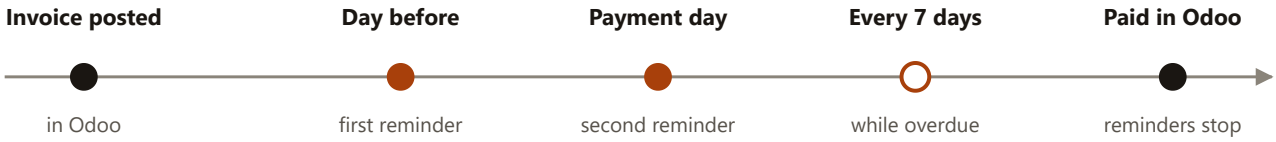
Customers can also set a minimum shelf life (for example 90 days). If only shorter-dated stock is available, they see the expiry date and must tick to accept it before ordering.

7 · JOURNEY 4

Payment reminders on each customer's schedule

The platform reminds; it does not collect. Customers pay as they do today and Finance records payments in Odoo. The Sales Manager sets each credit customer's schedule on S07.

Schedule	Example	Payment day
Invoice due date (default)	30 days after the invoice, from the Odoo payment terms	Each invoice's due date
Weekly	Every Wednesday	That weekday, every week
Monthly	The 25th of each month	That date, every month



Blocking rule: only going over the credit limit blocks new orders.

A missed payment day or an overdue invoice triggers reminders, not a block. Cash customers get no reminders.

Reminders go by email first; SMS or WhatsApp once a provider is chosen. Each one lists only that customer's own open invoices, and every reminder is logged.

Credit check before an order is sent: available credit = credit limit − amount owed − open orders not yet invoiced. Example: limit 10,000, owed 6,000, an earlier order of 2,500 waiting for approval leaves **GHS 1,500**, not 4,000.

Customer screens (phone)

Screen	What is on it	Rules it follows	Phase
C01 Sign in	Phone or email and password; a one-time code on a new phone; link to register; browse without signing in.	Visitors see the catalogue without prices.	2
C02 Register	Company, name, phone, email, delivery address; "waiting for approval" afterwards.	Duplicate check before the Sales Manager approves it as credit or cash.	2
C03 Catalogue	Search, category chips, product cards with pack, price per carton, stock status, Add to request; short-expiry clearance cards.	Hidden products never appear; prices only for approved customers.	2–3
C04 Product	Name, price, barcode, pack, category, availability, carton stepper; shelf-life warning with an accept tick.	A customer below their minimum shelf life must accept before adding.	2–3
C05 My request	Lines with prices and total; available credit; delivery address; Submit.	Submit blocked when over available credit.	4–5
C06 Orders	Every order, from BFL or Odoo, with the Odoo number and status: received, waiting for approval, approved, dispatched, invoiced, paid.	Status read back from Odoo.	4
C07 Balance	Available credit, credit limit, amount owed, overdue; open invoices with their order number; payments; statement download.	Every figure from Odoo; never calculated by BFL.	5
C08 Request (cash)	The same cart without the credit box; "total to pay in cash"; the buyer's name, phone and address for the order note.	No credit check for cash customers.	4
C09 Account (cash)	The buyer's details and only their BFL orders; how to apply for a company credit account.	Never shows the shared cash account's data.	4

Sales rep screens (phone)

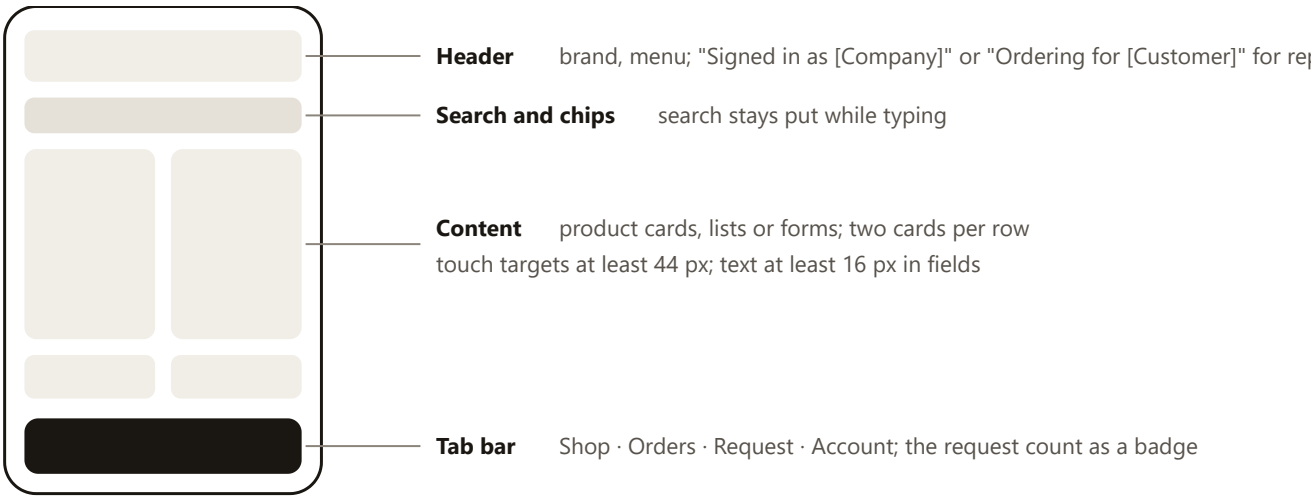
Screen	What is on it	Rules it follows	Phase
R01 My visits	Shops with open expiry alerts, nearest expiry first; find a customer by Odoo ID or name; overdue visits highlighted.	Only the rep's own customers, as assigned in Odoo.	7
R02 Visit form	Per lot: cartons on the shelf, photo, outcome (sold, propose discount, return, not checked), customer contact and agreement tick.	A discount is only a proposal until the Sales Manager approves it.	7

8 · EVERY SCREEN

Staff screens (desktop)

Screen	What is on it	Rules it follows	Phase
S01 Approvals	New registrations with duplicate check, customer type (credit or cash), rep and price class; discounts proposed by reps.	Credit customers are created in Odoo on approval; cash customers are not.	2, 7
S02 Visibility rules	Hide products by brand, category or product for a customer or group; preview of what they see.	Enforced on the server everywhere; every change logged.	2
S03 Expiry list	Lots by band (expired, critical, warning, early); action, owner, decide-by date, status; entries to check for typing mistakes.	Moves and write-offs are done in Odoo; rows close by themselves.	7
S04 Returns to classify	Every new Odoo return with its reason: damaged, expired or other.	Unclassified after 3 days shows on the dashboard.	7
S05 Sync health	Last successful sync per data type; outbox pending, sent and failed; Retry; the kill switch note.	Alerts before staff or customers notice a problem.	1
S06 Monthly reports	The CEO summary (12 measures), the Sales Manager and Warehouse reports; three explanation lines; PDF and CSV.	No cost data; company-wide figures for managers only.	1 onward
S07 Payments due	Due this week, overdue, reminders sent; each customer's schedule and the schedule editor.	Schedules set by the Sales Manager only.	6

Anatomy of a phone screen



9 · HOW THE FRONT END IS BUILT

Plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript, phone first, built on what already works

The customer catalogue was rewritten in October 2026 without any framework, and every new screen follows the same approach: no build step and nothing loaded from outside, so pages are light on low-end phones and slow networks, and there is less to break or update.

Building blocks shared by all screens

Component	Used on
Header and phone menu	Every customer and rep screen
Tab bar with request badge	C03 to C09
Product card and carton stepper (− number +)	C03, C04, C05, C08; already built and tested
Status pill (waiting, approved, dispatched, invoiced, paid, overdue)	C06, C07, C09, staff lists
Staff sidebar, tables, filters and CSV download	S01 to S07
Form fields with labels and error messages	C01, C02, C05, R02, S01, S02, S07

Rules every screen follows

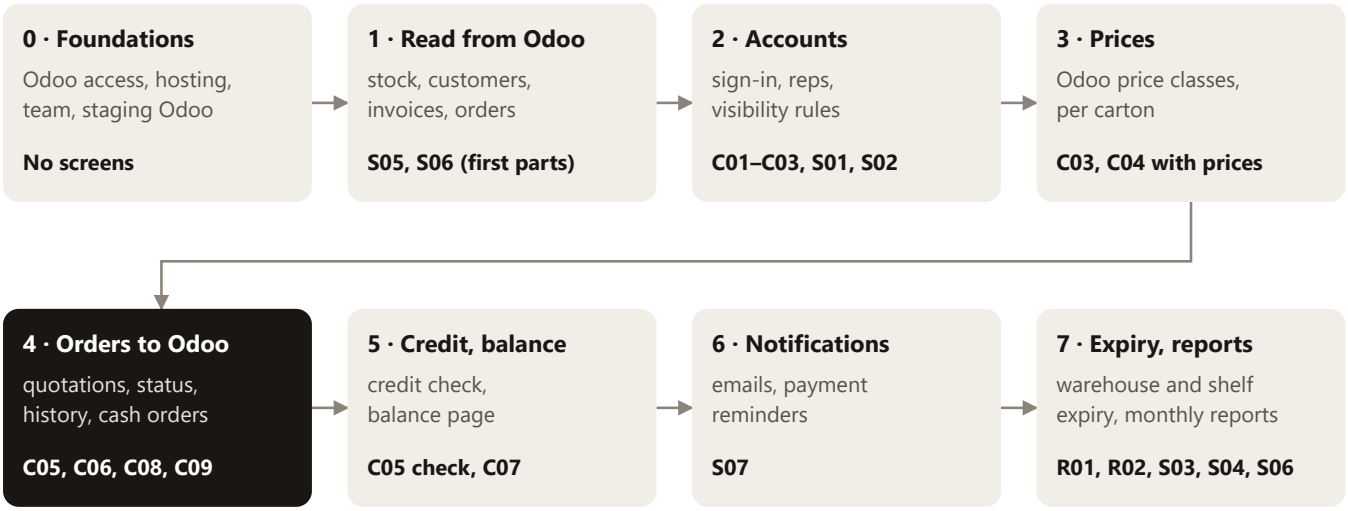
- **Security on the server:** who is signed in, which customer they belong to and what they may see is decided by the server on every request. Hiding on screen is never enough.
- **No data leaks:** automated tests check that no customer ever receives another customer's data, cost prices, hidden products or company figures.
- **Typing never breaks:** a field someone types into is built once and never redrawn, so the phone keyboard never closes mid-typing.
- **Accessible:** real buttons and labelled fields, readable contrast, touch targets of at least 44 px.
- **Slow networks:** loading placeholders instead of blank pages; an order is saved at once and sent to Odoo in the background.
- **The current look:** white, ink black and burnt orange, as in today's catalogue.

How the work is done

1. **Wireframes approved** by the Operations & Development lead and the Sales Manager (the clickable canvas).
2. **Front end built against test data** while the back end connects to the Odoo copy, so neither waits for the other.
3. **Every change reviewed** by the other developer, kept in the company's GitHub, with automated tests.
4. **Each phase tested on staging** by the Sales Manager against real cases, then signed off before going live.

10 · BUILD ORDER AND THE NEXT STEP

Eight phases, each released only after a sign-off



Each arrow is a gate: the phase checklist is signed off on staging before it goes live. Durations are set by the team after Phase 0.

What the CEO is asked to approve

- The budget and the two developers (front end and back end), with code owned by Box for Less.
- Lifting the hold on going online: a host, a company domain and HTTPS.
- Odoo API access, a staging copy of Odoo and a user seat for the integration user.

What the sales team is asked to do

- **Clean the Odoo data:** merge duplicate customers, give every customer a salesperson, a price class, a credit limit (credit customers) and a phone or email.
- **Fill the Brand field** on every product, for brand visibility rules and sales by brand.
- **Approve the wireframes** and the customer-facing wording: privacy notice, order terms, clearance and shelf-life rules.
- **Enter monthly targets** per rep, and test each phase on staging before it goes live.

Detailed rules, Odoo field lists and every acceptance checklist are in the technical specification; the full readiness checklist is its fourth tab.

APPENDIX

Words used in this document

Word	Meaning
Odoo	Box for Less's ERP: sales, contacts, inventory, invoicing. The master of all data.
BFL platform	The customer and staff web app described here, connected to Odoo.
Quotation	A draft order in Odoo. Orders from BFL arrive as quotations and become orders when the Sales Manager confirms them.
Price class	An Odoo pricelist. Each credit customer has one; new customers get the default one.
Credit limit, available credit	The most a customer may owe; what is left after amounts owed and open orders.
Cash customer account	The one Odoo account shared by all cash buyers.
Lot	A batch of one product with one expiry date, recorded at receipt and on every delivery.
Clearance location	The warehouse place for short-dated stock sold at a discount.
Integration user	The one Odoo user the platform connects as, with limited rights. Disabling it stops the connection.
Outbox	The platform's queue for sending quotations and new customers to Odoo safely, without duplicates.
Staging	A copy of the system and of Odoo used for testing before anything goes live.
Wireframe	A simple drawing of a screen, used to agree the layout before it is built.